

Tuesday, 25 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

25° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

25° 13°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

23° 14°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

20° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Burnham vows support for Ukraine despite 'outrageous threats' from Russia.

It comes after Moscow warned of "consequences" over the reported use of British drones by Ukraine.

UK · NEWS

2

Prince Harry steps down from African wildlife charity board.

Last year the organisation African Parks admitted human rights abuses were committed by its rangers in Congo-Brazzaville.

UK · NEWS

3

'It's not Alton Towers' - rows break out over queuing at Wales' highest mountain.

There has been disagreement between queuers and others skipping the line to reach the top of Yr Wyddfa.

UK · NEWS

4

Race Across the World star dies year after son.

Former TV contestant, Jo Gardiner, 61, dies of cancer one year after her son's death in a crash.

UK · NEWS

5

Teen pleads guilty over Channel boat with 165 migrants.

A man admits endangering lives at sea after piloting a dinghy with a then-record number of migrants.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Dutch broadcaster Avrotros pulls out of 2027 Eurovision Song Contest.**
It says contest can no longer be considered neutral while a participating country remains involved in a large-scale military conflict.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Race Across the World star dies year after son.**
Former TV contestant, Jo Gardiner, 61, dies of cancer one year after her son's death in a crash.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Viral 'Cat in the Hat' TikTok trend sparks fun fake videos but also real fear.**
The social media posts have prompted police forces in Ireland and the UK to issue statements that the images are fake.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 What happened to Harry and Meghan's American dream?.**
Harry and Meghan enjoyed some showbusiness success, but their Hollywood reign proved short-lived.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 In pictures: Hayden Panettiere's life and career, from child actor to Scream star.**
The former child star whose breakthrough came in 2006 later opened up about her struggles with mental health.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Former world snooker champion Dott guilty of child sex abuse.**
The former world champion was found guilty of lewd and libidinous behaviour towards a girl and boy.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Does Elliott have a Liverpool future after latest omission?.**
Harvey Elliott's position at Liverpool looks uncertain following his absence from the matchday squad at Newcastle on the opening weekend of the Premier League season.
SPORT · UK
- 3 McInnes could be in stand for first Old Firm game.**
Derek McInnes could be in the stand for his first Old Firm match as Rangers manager after a hearing date of 31 August was set for his appeal against a touchline ban.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Boks drop Feinberg-Mngomezulu to bench for All Blacks rematch.**
Sacha Feinberg-Mngomezulu pays for an indifferent showing in South Africa's series opener against New Zealand, as the fly-half drops to the Springbok bench.
SPORT · UK
- 5 Mateta's contract claim leaves Palace with transfer decision.**
Following a dispute over the length of his contract, will Jean-Philippe Mateta stay at Crystal Palace beyond the transfer window?
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Community 'little libraries' — swap-a-book boxes on the street — are popping up in more neighbourhoods.**
The unwritten rule is take one, leave one. The most-swapped genre, organisers say, is the holiday thriller.
- 2 Reusable coffee cups are finally outnumbering disposables in some city centres.**
Cafés offering a small discount have seen the biggest shift. The catch: most of us still leave the cup at home half the time.
- 3 More of us are learning the names of the birds in our gardens, apps report.**
Bird-ID apps have made spotting easier. The robin remains the nation's clear favourite, mostly for its cheek.
- 4 A poll finds most people have a song that instantly makes them feel like dancing, even in the kitchen.**
Kitchen discos are a quiet national pastime. The wooden spoon remains the microphone of choice.
- 5 The crossword and puzzle boom is still going strong, in print and on phones.**
Publishers report a surge in daily puzzlers. The most argued-over answer in households remains anything involving a cryptic clue.
- 6 A study suggests humming or singing badly in the car genuinely lifts your mood.**
Researchers link it to deep breathing and a small dose of joy. Fellow drivers at the lights may not share the enthusiasm.
- 7 A poll says most people can't remember the last time they wrote a letter by hand.**
Yet greetings-card sales remain strong — we'll happily sign our name, just not write a full page.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 74% of us have done **THIS** to avoid talking to someone we know in a supermarket.

ANSWER: PRETENDED TO BE FASCINATED BY A SHELF OF BEANS.

Q The most common thing we say we'll 'start on Monday' is **THIS**.

ANSWER: THE DIET – AGAIN.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says most people keep a ticket, photo or trinket from a day that changed their life.**
What's the keepsake you'll never throw away — and what's the story behind it?

- **Apparently the average person has one skill that always impresses people.**
What's your party trick — and when did you discover you could do it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Tech.** A start-up has invented a wearable that gently vibrates to remind you to drink water — and reportedly raised £3 million in two days on Kickstarter.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Researchers at Manchester University have built an AI that can predict which biscuit you'll dunk in your tea next, based only on the way you hold the mug.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A teaspoon of neutron star would weigh billions of tonnes on Earth.
- Sharks can sense a single drop of blood in an Olympic-sized swimming pool's worth of water.
- The word 'avocado' comes from an old Aztec word, and so does 'chocolate'.
- Crocodiles can't stick their tongues out.
- The UK's oldest known pub claims a history going back over a thousand years.
- A cockroach can live for a week or so without its head.
- More than half the bones in your body are in your hands and feet.
- Saturn isn't the only planet with rings — Jupiter, Uranus and Neptune have them too, just fainter.

On this day

Day 237 of the year, 128 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æbbe of Coldingham; Christian feast day: Aredius; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Arles; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Anthony Heald, American actor
- 1969 — Cameron Mathison, Canadian actor and television personality
- 1987 — Blake Lively, American model and actress
- 1938 — Frederick Forsyth, English journalist and author (died 2025)
- 1968 — Stuart Murdoch, Scottish singer-songwriter
- 1939 — Marshall Brickman, Brazilian-American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2024)
- 1974 — Eric Millegan, American actor
- 1960 — Ashley Crow, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1980 — The last performance of the Jahrhundertring at the Bayreuth Festival receives ovations of 45 minutes.
- 2003 — NASA successfully launches the Spitzer Space Telescope into space.
- 1989 — Voyager 2 spacecraft makes its closest approach to Neptune, the last planet in the Solar System at the time, due to Pluto being within Neptune's orbit from 1979 to 1999.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2010 — A Filair Let L-410 Turbolet crashes on approach to Bandundu Airport, killing 20.
- 1958 — The world's first publicly marketed instant noodles, Chikin Ramen, are introduced by Taiwanese-Japanese businessman Momofuku Ando.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — Bar Harbor Airlines Flight 1808 crashes near Auburn/Lewiston Municipal Airport in Auburn, Maine, killing all eight people on board including peace activist and child actress Samantha Smith.
- 1945 — The August Revolution ends as Emperor Bảo Đại abdicates, ending the Nguyễn dynasty.

- 1948 — The House Un-American Activities Committee holds first-ever televised congressional hearing: "Confrontation Day" between Whittaker Chambers and Alger Hiss.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 238 of the year, 127 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Bergamo (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Ceferino Namuncurá; Christian feast day: Jeanne-Elisabeth Bichier des Ages; Christian feast day: Blessed John Paul I. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Nik Turner, English musician and songwriter (died 2022)
- 2002 — Lil Tecca, American rapper
- 1941 — Jane Marrow, English actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1970 — Melissa McCarthy, American actress, comedian, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Alison Steadman, English actress
- 1941 — Chris Curtis, English drummer and singer (died 2005)
- 1940 — Michael Cockerell, English journalist
- 1980 — Macaulay Culkin, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2014 — The Jay Report into the Rotherham child sexual exploitation scandal is published.
- 1980 — After John Birges plants a bomb at Harvey's Resort Hotel in Stateline, Nevada, in the United States, the FBI inadvertently detonates the bomb during its disarming.
- 2021 — During the 2021 Kabul airlift, a suicide bombing at Hamid Karzai International Airport kills 13 US military personnel and at least 169 Afghan civilians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1966 — The South African Border War starts with the battle at Omugulugwombashe.
- 2018 — Three people are killed and eleven wounded during a mass shooting at a Madden NFL '19 video game tournament in Jacksonville, Florida.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar